

New Ground: Evidence on the Table

新的起点：摆上桌面的证据

Theme: 大学生活与个人成长 · New: 45 · Review: 18 · Planned cumulative progress: 45/6, 127

English Story

Among the **three hundred** replies, only a **hundred** described a door that failed. **Yes, those** answers **also** included complaints about buses, and the **amount** of noise in the **chat** was **remarkable**. “A survey is not evidence,” Professor Zhao said, “until you can **characterize** what it leaves out.” **Three** people came to the table in person: a **girl** from a **suburban** district, a **waitress** who worked nights, and a **lass** who cleaned the laboratories before dawn.

The **lady** who ran the hostel and a **gentleman** from the alumni office sat with them. **Mister** Chen, the porter, brought a plate of **ice cream**, and the room began to **brighten**. Nobody altered the record. **Whichever** version they chose, the **merit** of the argument depended on one **costly** detail: the ramp had never been built. **Supposedly** it existed in a plan from 2019, and the **glory** of that plan lasted exactly one afternoon.

Maya kept her **grasp** on the practical question. A **seedling** in a cracked pot stood on the windowsill, and its **odorous** soil filled the small room. She had no talent for **algebra** and no interest in an **empress** or an **ornament**; she wanted a **graceful** sentence and a working door. At **dusk** she watched the light change and **momentarily** lost the thread of her own argument.

A **waitress** told them that an angry customer had once tried to force the gate. He had told the locked door to **fuck** off, and the room went quiet for a moment. **Amidst** the laughter that followed, the point stood: a locked door makes people angry. **Lest** they forget it, Maya pinned the **shortcoming** of the old design to the wall. An **ornamental** **hostess** trolley, a **manly** poster about endurance, and a photograph of an old empire were no substitute for a ramp.

The team agreed to **familiarize** themselves with the site before the next meeting. Maya, who often walked along the corridor after **dusk**, was willing to test every door herself. **Wherever** a door failed, they would mark it with a creative, suitable tag, equally visible by day and by night. Regarding the old plan, she said: “Good lord, we have to illustrate the failures, not merely list them.” A **hilly** district and a **suburban** one had produced completely different answers, and the **saving** in effort was the real discovery. Recently they had learned this lesson the hard way; otherwise they would still be arguing about posters. “Obviously,” Lin said, “we cannot depend on a plan drawn ago by people who never came here.” Plenty of folk had said the same thing for years; neither of them had listened, and the evidence was on the table, though they had yet to achieve anything.

中文翻译

在三百份回复中，只有一百份描述了打不开的门。是的，那些回答里也包含对公交的抱怨，群聊里的噪声量大得惊人。“问卷不是证据，”赵教授说，“直到你能说清它漏掉了什么。”有三个人亲自来到桌边：一名来自郊区行政区的女孩、一名上夜班的女服务员，还有一名天亮前打扫实验室的姑娘。

经营宿舍的女士和一位校友会的先生和他们坐在一起。门房陈先生端来一盘冰淇淋，房间开始亮堂起来。没有人改动记录。无论他们选哪个版本，论点的价值都取决于一个代价高昂的细节：那条坡道从未建成。据说它存在于2019年的一份图纸里，而那份图纸的荣光只维持了一个下午。

曼雅牢牢抓住实际问题。窗台上有一盆裂了的花盆里的幼苗，带着气味的泥土弥漫在小房间里。她对代数毫无天赋，对皇后或装饰品也毫无兴趣；她想要的是一句优美的句子和一扇能用的门。黄昏时她看着光线变化，一时间失去了自己论证的线索。

一名女服务员告诉他们，曾有一位愤怒的顾客试图强行推开大门。他对着锁住的门骂了一句脏话，房间里安静了片刻。在随之而来的笑声中，那个要点依然成立：锁住的门会让人愤怒。为了不让他们忘掉，曼雅把旧设计的缺点钉在墙上。一辆装饰用的女主人推车、一张关于忍耐的阳刚海报、一张旧帝国的照片，都替代不了一条坡道。

团队约定在下次会议前先熟悉现场。玛雅常在黄昏后沿着走廊走，她愿意亲自去试每一扇门。哪里的门出了问题，他们就在那里贴上一个有创意又合适的标签，让人白天和夜里都同样看得清。说到那张旧图纸，她说：“老天，我们得把失败之处讲清楚，而不只是把它们列出来。”一个丘陵学区和一个郊区学区给出了完全不同的答案，而真正的发现是省下来的那些力气。最近他们才以艰难的方式学到这一课；否则他们到现在还在为海报争吵。“显而易见，”林伟说，“我们不能依赖一张由从未到过这里的人很久以前画出的图纸。”很多普通人多年来都说过同样的话。他们俩谁也没听，而证据现在终于摆上了桌面。他们还没有做成任何事，但问题本身已经变了。

Core Vocabulary · 核心词汇

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
also 'ɒ:lsoʊ POS: adv	adv. 也, 并且, 同样地 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: r in addition
those ðəʊz POS: pron	pron. 那些 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: pron. The plural of that. See That.
three θri: POS: num	num. 三, 三个 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the cardinal number that is the sum of one and one and one; s. being one more than two
yes jes POS: adv	adv. 是; n. 是, 同意; v. 同意 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an affirmative
among ə'mʌŋ POS: prep	prep. 在...之中 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: prep. Alt. of Amongst
girl ge:l POS: n	n. 女孩, 少女, 女佣 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a young woman; n. a friendly informal reference to a grown woman
hundred 'hʌndrəd POS: n	n. 百, 百个东西; num. 百, 百个; a. 一百的, 许多的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. ten 10s; s. being ten more than ninety
amount ə'maʊnt POS: n	n. 总数, 总额; vi. 总计, 等同 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the relative magnitude of something with reference to a criterion; v. be tantamount or equivalent to
lady 'leɪdi POS: n	n. 淑女, 夫人, 女士, 贵妇 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a polite name for any woman; n. a woman of the peerage in Britain
gentleman 'dʒentlmən POS: n	n. 绅士, 先生 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a man of refinement
alter 'ɒ:lteɪ POS: v	v. 改变 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. make an alteration to; v. remove the ovaries of
saving 'seɪvɪŋ POS: n	n. 存款, 挽救, 节约; a. 搭救的, 节约的, 保留的, 补偿的; prep. 除...之外 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. characterized by thriftiness
remarkable rɪ'mɑ:kəbl POS: a	a. 不平常的, 值得注意的, 显著的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. unusual or striking
characterize 'kærəktəraɪz POS: vt	vt. 描绘...的特性, 刻画...的性格 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. be characteristic of
wherever hwɛə'eɪvə POS: adv	adv. 无论哪里 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: r. where in the world
suburban sə'be:bən POS: a	a. 郊外的, 郊区的, (贬)偏狭的, 土气的, 见识不广的; n. 郊区居民 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. relating to or characteristic of or situated in suburbs
merit 'merɪt POS: n	n. 优点, 功绩, 价值, 功过, 真相; vt. 值得; vi. 应受 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. any admirable quality or attribute
glory 'glɔ:ri POS: n	n. 光荣, 荣耀, 荣誉, 壮丽, 繁荣; vi. 自豪 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a state of high honor; n. brilliant radiant beauty; v. rejoice proudly
grasp græsp POS: n	n. 把握, 抓紧, 理解, 抓, 柄, 控制; vt. 抓住, 紧握, 领会; vi. 抓 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. hold firmly
costly 'kɒstli POS: a	a. 昂贵的, 奢华的, 费用大的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. having a high price
supposedly sə'pəʊzɪdli POS: adv	adv. 想象上, 看上去像, 被认为是, 恐怕, 按照推测 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: r believed or reputed to be the case
chat tʃæt POS: n	n. 闲谈; vi. 闲谈, 聊天 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an informal conversation
fuck fʌk POS: vt	vt. 与...性交, 欺骗, 诅咒; vi. 性交; n. 性交, 些微, 杂种; interj. 他妈的, 混帐 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. slang for sexual intercourse
whichever hwɪtʃ'eɪvə POS: pron	pron. 无论那一个, 任何一个 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: pron. & a. Alt. of Whichsoever
waitress 'weɪtrɪs POS: n	n. 女侍者, 女服务员 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a woman waiter

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
dusk dʌsk POS: n	n. 薄暮, 傍晚, 黄昏; a. 微暗的; v. (使)微暗 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. become dusk
graceful ˈɡreɪsful POS: a	a. 优美的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. characterized by beauty of movement, style, form, or execution
ornament ˈɒ:nəmənt POS: n	n. 装饰, 点缀品, 教堂用品; vt. 装饰, 修饰 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. be an ornament to
brighten ˈbraɪtn POS: vi	vi. 变亮, 活跃; vt. 使生辉, 使快活 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. make lighter or brighter
momentarily ˈməʊməntərɪli POS: adv	adv. 暂时地, 立刻, 随时地 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: r. for an instant or moment; r. at any moment
shortcoming ˈʃɔ:tˈkʌmɪŋ POS: n	n. 缺点, 短处 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n a failing or deficiency
mister ˈmɪstə POS: n	n. 先生 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a form of address for a man
amidst əˈmɪdst POS: prep	prep. 在...当中 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: prep. Alt. of Amid
lest lest POS: conj	conj. 以免, 唯恐, 免得 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s being ten more than forty
lass læs POS: n	n. 少女, 爱人, 情妇 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a girl or young woman who is unmarried
ornamental ˌɒ:nəˈmentl POS: n	n. 装饰物, 观赏植物; a. 装饰性的, 装饰的, 观赏用的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. any plant grown for its beauty or ornamental value
hostess ˈhəʊstɪs POS: n	n. 女主人, 女房东, 女老板 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a woman host; n. a woman innkeeper
seedling ˈsi:dlɪŋ POS: n	n. 秧苗, 树苗; [医] 籽苗, 幼苗, 实生苗 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. young plant or tree grown from a seed
algebra ˈældʒɪbrə POS: n	n. 代数学 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the mathematics of generalized arithmetical operations
empress ˈemprɪs POS: n	n. 皇后, 女皇 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a woman emperor or the wife of an emperor
manly ˈmænli POS: a	a. 象男人的, 强壮的, 适于男人的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. possessing qualities befitting a man
hilly ˈhɪli POS: a	a. 多丘陵的, 多山岗的, 险峻的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s having hills and crags
familiarize fəˈmɪljəraɪz POS: vt	vt. 使熟悉, 使熟知, 使通俗化 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. make familiar or conversant with
odorous ˈəʊdərəs POS: a	a. 芬芳的, 臭的, 有气味的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. having odor or a characteristic odor
ice cream phonetic unavailable POS: review required	冰淇淋; [化] 冰淇淋 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: No reliable source example available.